

Absolutely — **minor** is an excellent Tier 1 polysemy target because your passage uses it here:

> “...social media can turn an ordinary student into a **minor celebrity** overnight...”

Here **minor** means **not major; relatively small or limited in importance, fame, size, or effect**. But the word also has important meanings involving **underage people, academic subjects, music, medicine, law, and lesser-ranking categories**.

Word family: **minor / minority**

Base word: minor

Part of speech: adjective (形容詞) / noun (名詞)

Related noun: minority

Meaning in your passage: **minor = relatively small / not major** — 小有名氣的；較小程度的；次要的

Your phrase:

> “a **minor celebrity**”

Here **minor** means:

> **someone who is somewhat well known, but not a major or widely famous celebrity.**

繁體中文：

有一定知名度，但名氣不算很大、並非頂級或廣為人知的

Natural translation:

> “a minor celebrity”

「一個**小有名氣的人 / 小明星**」

So here:

> **minor = 程度較小、重要性或影響力較低的**

1. **minor = small in importance, degree, or seriousness** — 次要的；輕微的；較小的

The broad core adjective meaning.

Practice 1

> “The problem was only **minor**.”

「這個問題只是**小問題 / 不嚴重**。」

Practice 2

> “There were a few minor changes.”

「有幾項**小幅度的改動**。」

minor = 程度、重要性、影響或嚴重性較低的

2. **minor** = not very famous / less important — 小有名氣的；較次要的

This is your exact source sense.

Practice 3 — Original

> “He became a **minor celebrity** online.”

「他在網上變成了一個**小有名氣的人**。」

Practice 4

> “She played a minor role in the film.”

「她在電影中飾演一個**次要角色**。」

minor = 在地位、知名度、重要性或影響力上不屬於主要 / 頂級層級的

3. **minor** = slight / not serious in injury or damage — 輕微的

A very common medical/safety sense.

Practice 5

> “He suffered only **minor injuries**.”

「他只受了**輕傷**。」

Practice 6

> “The car had minor damage.”

「汽車只有**輕微損壞**。」

minor = 傷勢、損害或問題程度不嚴重的

4. **minor = noun, person under legal adult age — 未成年人**

A major legal noun sense.

Practice 7

> “The law gives extra protection to **minors**.”

「法律對**未成年人**提供額外保障。」

Practice 8

> “A minor may need parental consent.”

「**未成年人**可能需要家長同意。」

minor — noun = 尚未達到法定成年年齡的人

This is genuinely distinct from the adjective.

5. **minor = academic secondary field of study — 副修；副修科目**

A major academic noun sense, especially in North American English.

Practice 9

> “Her major is economics and her **minor** is psychology.”

「她主修經濟，**副修**心理學。」

Practice 10

> “He completed a minor in history.”

「他完成了歷史**副修**。」

minor — education = 大學中相對於主修科目較次要的第二專修領域

6. **minor** = to study a secondary subject — 副修

Verb use, especially AmE.

Practice 11

> “She **minored** in French.”

「她大學時**副修法文**。」

Practice 12

> “He majored in biology and **minored** in chemistry.”

「他主修生物，**副修化學**。」

minor in + subject = 以某科作為副修

This is a useful POS shift.

7. **minor** = musical key/scale — 小調的

A major music sense.

Practice 13

> “The song is written in a **minor key**.”

「這首歌是以**小調**寫成的。」

Practice 14

> “The melody shifts from major to **minor**.”

「旋律由**大調轉為小調**。」

minor — music = 屬於小調音階 / 和聲系統的

This is completely different from “less important”.

8. **minor = noun, minor key/scale/chord context — 小調**

Practice 15

> “The piece moves into the **minor**.”

「這首作品轉入**小調**。」

Practice 16

> “The ending is in C minor.”

「結尾是 C **小調**。」

minor — music noun = 小調調性

9. **minor = lesser-ranking category / lower level — 次級的；較低級的**

A broader classification sense.

Practice 17

> “The team plays in a **minor league**.”

「這支球隊參加**次級聯賽**。」

Practice 18

> “The road is a minor route compared with the motorway.”

「跟高速公路相比，這是一條**次要道路**。」

minor = 在等級、規模或層級上低於主要類別的

10. **minor = less serious offence — 輕微的；較輕級別的**

A legal/administrative adjective sense.

Practice 19

> “It was treated as a **minor offence**.”

「這被視為**輕微罪行**。」

Practice 20

> “He received a warning for a minor violation.”

「他因一項**輕微違規**而受到警告。」

minor = 在法律 / 規章上嚴重程度較低的

11. **minor = less severe medical procedure/condition — 小型的；較輕微的**

A medical classification use.

Practice 21

> “She underwent **minor surgery**.”

「她接受了**小型手術**。」

Practice 22

> “The procedure is considered minor.”

「這項程序被視為**較小型 / 風險較低**。」

minor — medicine = 相對簡單、風險較低、創傷較小的

12. **minor = less important character/point/detail — 次要的**

A common analytical/literary sense.

Practice 23

> “That is only a **minor point**.”

「那只是一個**次要論點**。」

Practice 24

> “The story contains several minor characters.”

「故事裡有幾個**次要角色**。」

minor = 在整體中不屬於核心或主要部分的

13. **minority = smaller part of a group — 少數；少數群體**

A related family extension.

Practice 25

> “Only a **minority** of students disagreed.”

「只有**少數**學生不同意。」

Practice 26

> “The proposal was supported by a small minority.”

「這項提議只有一小部分**少數人**支持。」

minority = 在整體群體中人數較少的一部分

14. **minority = social/ethnic/religious minority group — 少數族群**

A major social meaning.

Practice 27

> “The policy affects ethnic minorities.”

「這項政策影響**少數族裔群體**。」

Practice 28

> “Religious minorities may face different challenges.”

「宗教**少數群體**可能面對不同挑戰。」

****minority = 在社會中人數較少、身份較少數的群體****

Important distinction: ****minor vs small****

****small****

= size/amount physically or numerically small.

****minor****

= importance, seriousness, rank, or effect is relatively low.

> small box

> = 小盒子

> minor problem

> = 小問題 / 不嚴重的問題

Not interchangeable in many contexts.

Important distinction: ****minor vs trivial****

****minor****

= relatively unimportant/small.

****trivial****

= so unimportant that it is almost not worth attention.

> minor issue

> = 次要問題

> trivial issue

> = 微不足道的問題

****Trivial** is stronger.**

Important distinction: ****minor vs major****

This is the core contrast.

major

= important, large, serious, principal.

minor

= less important, smaller, less serious, secondary.

> major injury

> = 重傷

> minor injury

> = 輕傷

> major role

> = 主要角色

> minor role

> = 次要角色

Important distinction: **minor celebrity vs unknown person**

minor celebrity

= has some public recognition.

unknown person

= not publicly known.

So **minor** does not mean “not famous at all”; it means **some fame, but limited fame**.

This is exactly your passage.

Important distinction: **minor celebrity vs major celebrity**

minor celebrity

= 小有名氣的人

major celebrity

= 高知名度名人

This contrast is about **degree of fame/status**.

Important distinction: **minor = underage vs minor = unimportant**

Noun:

> “He is a minor.”

= 他是未成年人。

Adjective:

> “It is a minor problem.”

= 這是一個小問題。

Same spelling, completely different grammar and meaning.

Excellent MCQ contrast.

Important distinction: **minor — academic vs minor — music**

Academic:

> “Her minor is history.”

= 她副修歷史。

Music:

> “The piece is in A minor.”

= 這首曲是 A 小調。

Completely different domains.

Important distinction: ****major/minor — academic****

****major****

= 主修

****minor****

= 副修

Example:

> major in economics

> = 主修經濟

> minor in psychology

> = 副修心理學

Important distinction: ****major/minor — music****

****major****

= 大調

****minor****

= 小調

Do not translate them as “主要 / 次要” in music.

Important distinction: ****minor surgery****

This does ****not**** mean:

> unimportant surgery

It means:

> relatively limited/small-scale procedure, usually lower risk than major surgery

So the natural Chinese is:

> ****小型手術****

not:

> 「次要手術」

Important distinction: ****minority vs minor****

****minor****

= adjective or noun:

* smaller/less important

* underage person

****minority****

= smaller group/portion.

> minor issue

> = 次要問題

> minority opinion

> = 少數意見

Family-extension sweep

After the full audit, the useful modern inventory includes:

* ****minor — importance/degree**** = 次要 / 較小程度的

* ****minor — fame/status**** = 小有名氣 / 較次要的

* ****minor — injury/damage**** = 輕微的

* ****minor — noun, underage person**** = 未成年人

* ****minor — academic noun**** = 副修

* ****minor in + subject**** = 副修.....

* ****minor — music**** = 小調的 / 小調

* ****minor — lower-level classification**** = 次級 / 較低級的

* ****minor — offence**** = 輕微罪行 / 違規

* ****minor — surgery/procedure**** = 小型的

* ****minor — point/character**** = 次要的

* ****minority — smaller group**** = 少數

* ****minority — social group**** = 少數群體

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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minor — general	程度、重要性、影響或嚴重性較低的
minor — fame/status	有一定知名度 / 地位，但並非主要或頂級的
minor — injury/damage	傷勢、損害或問題程度較輕微的
minor — noun	尚未達到法定成年年齡的人
minor — academic	大學中相對於主修科目較次要的副修領域
minor in + subject	以某科作為副修
minor — music	屬於小調音階 / 和聲系統的
minor — classification	在等級、規模或層級上低於主要類別的
minor offence	嚴重程度較低的違法 / 違規行為
minor surgery	相對小型、創傷或風險較低的手術
minority	整體中人數 / 比例較少的一部分或群體

For your original sentence

> “In an age when social media can turn an ordinary student into a **minor celebrity** overnight...”

The exact meaning is:

**minor = 因網上爆紅而獲得一定知名度，但還沒有達到真正大明星 / 高知名度名人的程度。 **

Natural translation:

> **「在這個社交媒體可以一夜之間把普通學生變成小有名氣人物的年代.....」 **

The highest-value contrasts are:

- > **minor problem** → 小問題 / 次要問題
- > **minor injury** → 輕傷
- > **minor celebrity** → 小有名氣的人
- > **a minor** → 未成年人
- > **minor in history** → 副修歷史
- > **A minor** → A 小調
- > **minor surgery** → 小型手術
- > **minor offence** → 輕微罪行
- > **minority** → 少數 / 少數群體